

EXPERIMENT 01

AIM

Design a PMOS Common Source (CS) amp using 180nm CMOS technology and have power and voltage limits and characterize the performance of the designed circuit using:

VDD=1.2V

$P \leq 0.4\text{mW}$

$CL = 0.5\text{pF}$

$L_n = 360\text{nm}$

1.DC Operating Point Analysis

2.Transient Analysis

3.AC Small-Signal Analysis

using LTspice.

COMPONENTS REQUIRED

- PMOS transistor (TSMC 180nm model)
- Resistor R_d
- DC voltage source
- Signal voltage source
- Capacitor
- Connecting wires

THEORY

The foundations of a contemporary electronic system/ IC are the Metal-oxide-semiconductor Field-effect transistor (MOSFET). The MOSFETs are widely used due to their:

- 1.Small dimension and simple design.
- 2.Low power consumption
- 3.High input impedance
- 4.The VLSI technology is highly scaled.

MOSFET may be built in either NMOS or PMOS and may be employed in 3 basic amplifier design:

- 1.Common Source (CS)
- 2.Widely Spread (Source Follower)
- 3.Common Gate (CG)

The most popular of these is the Common Source arrangement which is applied in the design of analog circuits as it has large voltage gain and signal inversion.

PMOS is operated in Saturation Region.

The amplifying PMOS transistor must be saturated in the saturation region whereby it is a voltage controlled current source.

Under saturation conditions in PMOS transistor:

1. $V_{SG} > |V_T|$
2. $V_{SD} \geq V_{SG} - |V_T|$

V_{SG} = Source-to-Gate voltage

V_{SD} = Source-to-Drain voltage

V_T = Threshold voltage of PMOS

$V_{OV} = V_{SG} - |V_T|$ (Overdrive voltage)

When these conditions are satisfied, the PMOS transistor operates in saturation and enables linear amplification.

PROCEDURE

1. Include Technology Model

The library file TSMC 180nm was included in LTspice with the.lib directive.

2. Build the PMOS CS Circuit.

The Common Source amplifier was built using the PMOS Common Source which involved connection:

- Source to VDD (1.2 V)
- Drain to a load resistor
- Gate to a DC bias with AC input
- Body tied to source
- Load capacitor at the output

3. Initial Device Parameters

The channel length in PMOS was the fixed constant which was 360 nm and an initial width value was picked.

4. DC Operating Point Analysis

The following command op was run to get the current through the drain and the voltage at the output.

5. Bias Adjustment that is needed.

The width of the PMOS was adjusted progressively until the required drain current and output voltage was obtained with the specified power constraint.

6. Saturation Verification

The saturation condition was confirmed so as to check the functioning of the amplifier.

7. Transient Analysis

DC-shifted sinusoidal input signal was applied and .tran analysis was done to monitor the time domain amplification and phase inversion

8. AC Small-Signal Analysis

The AC amplitude was adjusted to 1 V and the.ac analysis was done to receive voltage gain and frequency response.

9. Result Comparison

Theoretical calculations were compared to simulation results to prove the design of the amplifier

DESIGN CALCULATIONS

There is need to compute the anticipated operating conditions of the PMOS Common Source amplifier before the simulation is conducted. Such calculations are useful in choosing the correct bias values, and in ensuring that the transistor will be in the saturation region of operation.

1. Determination of Drain Current from Power

Given power constraint:

$$P \leq 0.4 \text{ mW}$$

$$V_{DD} = 1.2 \text{ V}$$

The DC power consumed by the circuit is:

$$P = V_{DD} \times I_D$$

Therefore,

$$I_D = P / V_{DD}$$

$$I_D = 0.4 \times 10^{-3} / 1.2 = 0.333 \text{ mA}$$

To maintain a safety margin and avoid exceeding the power limit, a design current of:

$$I_D \approx 250 \text{ }\mu\text{A}$$

2. Calculation Of PMOS Width (W)

To determine the required width of the PMOS transistor for the chosen drain current, the saturation current equation for PMOS is used:

$$\mu_p = 0.0115689 \text{ m}^2/\text{V}\cdot\text{s}$$

$$C_{ox} = 0.0084207 \text{ F/m}^2$$

$$L = 360 \text{ nm} = 360 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m}$$

$$V_{OV} = 0.2094 \text{ V}$$

$$I_D = 250 \text{ }\mu\text{A} = 250 \times 10^{-6} \text{ A}$$

$$I_D = (1/2) \times \mu_p \times C_{ox} \times (W/L) \times (V_{OV})^2$$

$$W = 42 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$$

3. Selection of Output Voltage

$$V_D \approx V_{DD} / 2$$

$$V_D \approx 1.2 / 2$$

$$\mathbf{V_D = 0.6\ V}$$

4. Calculation of Drain Load Resistance

Using Ohm's law:

$$R_D = V_D / I_D$$

$$R_D = 0.6 / (250 \times 10^{-6})$$

$$R_D = 2400\ \text{ohm}$$

$$\mathbf{R_D = 2.4\ \text{kilo-ohm}}$$

Thus, a drain resistor of 2.4 k Ω is selected.

5. Determination of Gate-Source Voltage and Overdrive Voltage

The threshold voltage magnitude is:

$$\mathbf{|V_T| = 0.3906\ V}$$

To ensure saturation operation, choose:

$$\mathbf{V_{SG} \approx 0.6\ V}$$

Overdrive voltage is:

$$V_{OV} = V_{SG} - |V_T|$$

$$V_{OV} = 0.6 - 0.3906$$

$$\mathbf{V_{OV} = 0.2094\ V}$$

6. Calculation of Gate Voltage

Since the source of the PMOS is connected to:

$$V_S = 1.2\ V$$

The required gate voltage is:

$$V_G = V_S - V_{SG}$$

$$V_G = 1.2 - 0.6$$

$$\mathbf{V_G = 0.6\ V}$$

7. Verification of Saturation Condition

For PMOS saturation:

$$\mathbf{V_{SD} \geq V_{OV}}$$

First calculate VSD:

$$V_{SD} = V_S - V_D$$

$$V_{SD} = 1.2 - 0.6$$

$$\mathbf{V_{SD} = 0.6\ V}$$

Since:

$$\mathbf{0.6\ V > 0.2094\ V}$$

The PMOS transistor operates in the saturation region.

Final Calculated Values

$$\text{Drain Current (ID)} = 250\ \mu\text{A}$$

$$\text{Output Voltage (VD)} = 0.6\ \text{V}$$

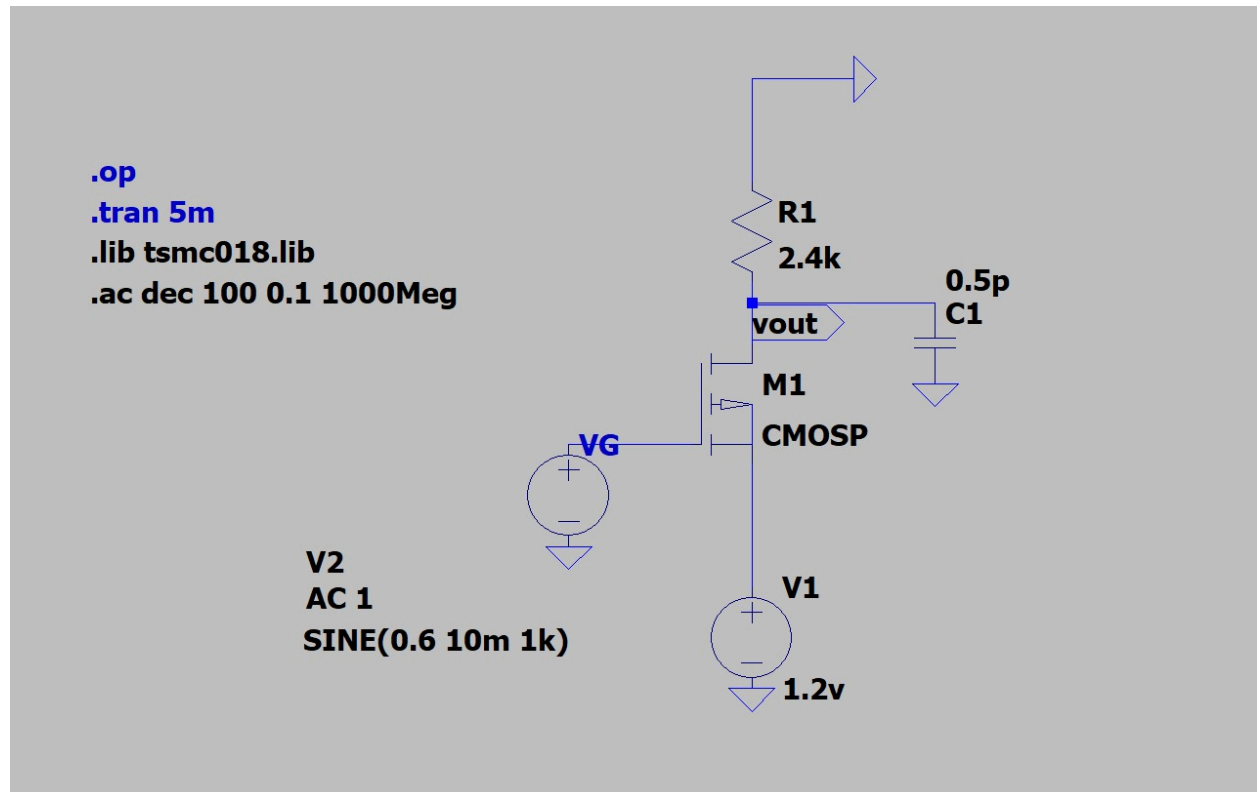
$$\text{Drain Resistor (RD)} = 2.4\ \text{kohm}$$

$$\text{Gate Voltage (VG)} = 0.6\ \text{V}$$

$$\text{Overdrive Voltage (VOV)} = 0.2094\ \text{V}$$

Saturation Condition = Verified

CIRCUIT



DC ANALYSIS

DC analysis is performed to determine the operating point (Q-point) of the MOSFET and to ensure that the transistor operates in the saturation region, which is necessary for proper amplification. Establishing a correct bias point prevents signal distortion and ensures linear operation of the amplifier.

This analysis helps in:

- Verifying that the MOSFET satisfies saturation conditions
- Determining drain current and output voltage
- Selecting appropriate biasing components
- Maintaining stable circuit operation against parameter variations

By fixing the DC operating point correctly, the amplifier achieves maximum performance, reliability, and signal integrity.

Q-POINT VERIFICATION USING DC OPERATING POINT ANALYSIS

After calculating the theoretical PMOS width as $W = 42 \text{ } \mu\text{m}$, DC operating point analysis was performed using the `.op` command in LTspice to verify the bias point.

The obtained simulation results were:

Drain current, $I_D = -0.000149608 \text{ A}$ (approximately $149 \text{ } \mu\text{A}$)

Output voltage, $V_{out} = 0.359058 \text{ V}$

These values are significantly lower than the expected theoretical values:

Expected $I_D \approx 250 \text{ } \mu\text{A}$

Expected $V_{out} \approx 0.6 \text{ V}$

The reduction in drain current and output voltage occurs due to short-channel effects and mobility degradation present in the realistic TSMC 180nm BSIM transistor model, which are not accounted for in the ideal square-law MOSFET equation.

WIDTH ADJUSTMENT FOR REQUIRED OPERATING POINT

To achieve the desired drain current and output voltage, the PMOS width was gradually increased while keeping all other parameters constant.

After iterative adjustment, the width was set to:

$W = 72 \text{ } \mu\text{m}$

The DC operating point was re-evaluated using the `.op` command.

The new operating point obtained was:

Drain current, $I_D \approx 247 \text{ uA}$

Output voltage, $V_{out} \approx 0.59 \text{ V}$

These values closely match the theoretical design targets.

```
--- Operating Point ---
V(n001):      0.6          voltage
V(n002):      1.07144      voltage
V(n003):      1.2          voltage
V(vout):      0.592962     voltage
I(C1):        2.96481e-25   device_current
I(R1):        -0.000247068  device_current
I(V1):        -0.000247068  device_current
I(V2):        0            device_current
Ib(M1):       -1.07145e-12  device_current
Id(M1):       -0.000247068  device_current
Ig(M1):       -0           device_current
Is(M1):       0.000247068   device_current
```

TRANSIENT ANALYSIS

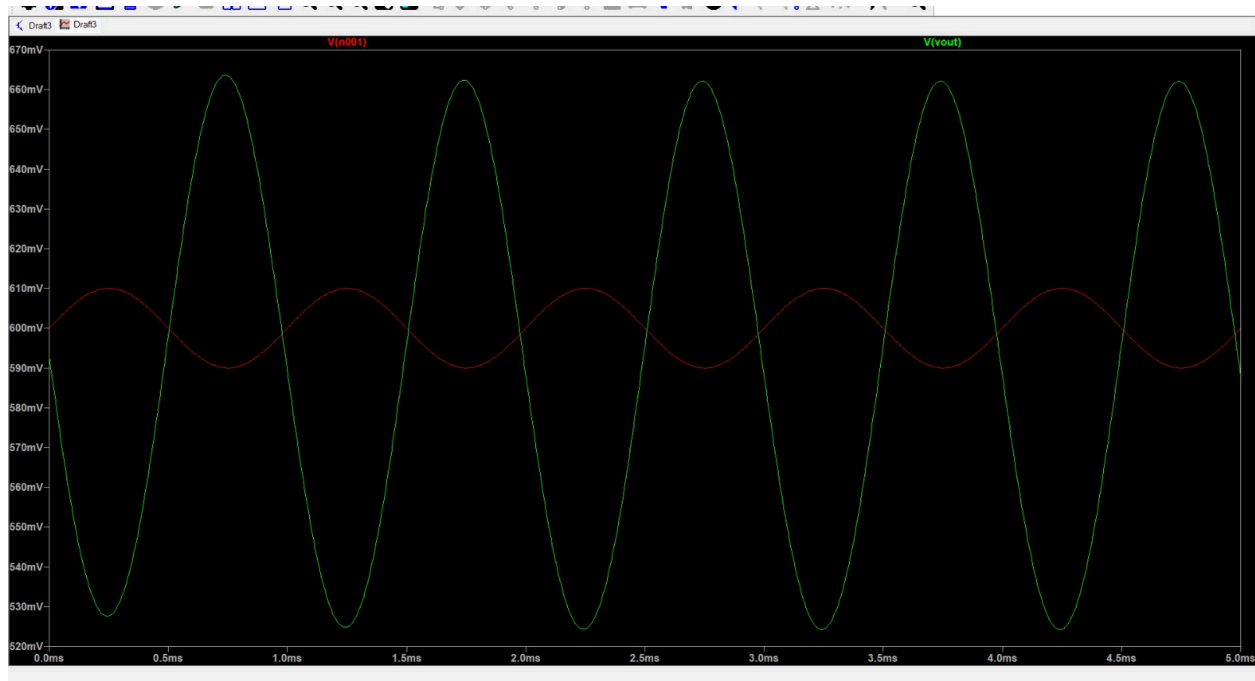
Transient analysis is used to study the circuit's response to time-varying input signals. It provides insight into how the amplifier behaves in real-time operation.

This analysis helps in:

- Observing signal amplification

- Identifying phase inversion
- Detecting distortion and waveform clipping
- Studying dynamic response of the circuit

Transient analysis is especially important in high-speed and communication circuits, where accurate signal reproduction is essential.



1. Gain Calculation

In transient analysis, the voltage gain is calculated using both theoretical formulas and simulation waveform measurements.

A. Theoretical Voltage Gain

For a Common Source amplifier:

$$A_v = -g_m \times R_D$$

First calculate transconductance:

$$g_m = 2 \times I_D / V_{OV}$$

Given:

$$I_D = 250 \mu A$$

$$V_{OV} = 0.2094 V$$

$$g_m = (2 \times 250 \times 10^{-6}) / 0.2094$$

$$g_m = 2.39 \text{ mS}$$

Now calculate gain:

$$A_v = g_m \times R_D$$

$$R_D = 2.4 \text{ kohm}$$

$$A_v = 0.00239 \times 2400$$

$$A_v = 5.736$$

Now convert to decibels:

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 20 \times \log_{10}(A_v)$$

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 20 \times \log_{10}(5.736)$$

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 15.16 \text{ dB}$$

B.Simulation Gain (From WaveForm)

From transient simulation:

$$\text{input p-p} = 20 \text{ mV}$$

$$\text{Output p-p} = 136.05 \text{ mV}$$

Voltage gain:

$$A_v = V_{out} / V_{in}$$

$$A_v = 136.05 / 20$$

$$A_v = 6.8025$$

Now convert to dB:

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 20 \times \log_{10}(6.8025)$$

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 20 \times 0.8326$$

$$\text{Gain (dB)} = 16.65 \text{ dB}$$

C.Comparison

Theoretical Gain = 15.16 dB

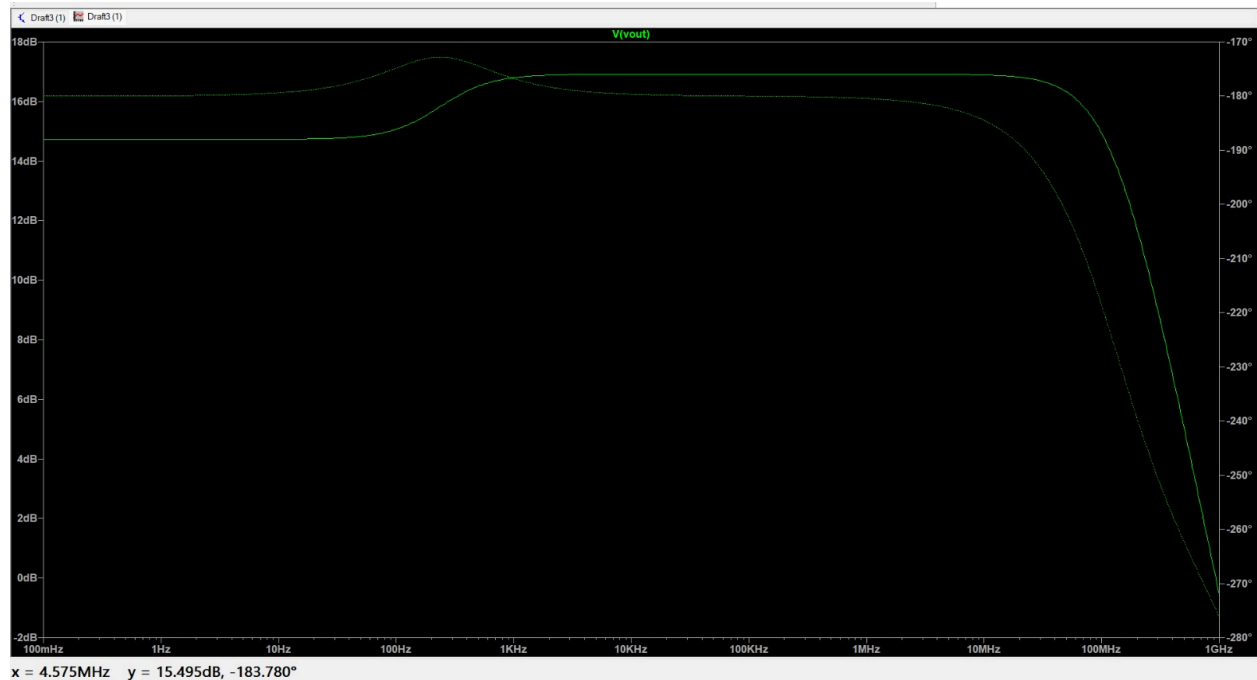
Simulation Gain = 16.65 dB

The slight difference occurs due to:

- Channel length modulation
 - Short channel effects
 - Output resistance (r_o)
-

AC ANALYSIS – GAIN AND BANDWIDTH CALCULATION

AC analysis is performed to determine the frequency response of the PMOS Common Source amplifier. From the AC magnitude plot, the mid-band voltage gain is obtained from the flat region of the frequency response, and the bandwidth is determined using the -3 dB cutoff frequency.



A. Mid Band Gain

From the flat portion of the AC magnitude plot:

Gain in dB = 16.912 dB

Convert to linear scale:

$$A_v = 10^{(\text{Gain(dB)}/20)}$$

$$A_v = 10^{(16.912/20)}$$

$A_v = 6.80 \text{ V/V}$

Thus, the mid-band voltage gain is:

$A_v \approx 6.8 \text{ V/V}$

B. Theoretical Bandwidth

The theoretical bandwidth of a single-pole amplifier is given by:

$$\text{BW} = 1 / (2 \times \pi \times R_D \times C_L)$$

Given:

$$R_D = 2.4 \text{ k}\Omega$$

$$C_L = 0.5 \text{ pF}$$

$$BW = 1 / (2 \times \pi \times 2400 \times 0.5 \times 10^{-12})$$

$$BW = 132.63 \text{ MHz}$$

C.Simulation Bandwidth

From the AC response plot, the **-3 dB cutoff frequency** is observed at:

$$BW_{\text{simulation}} \approx 131.8 \text{ MHz}$$

This frequency corresponds to the point where the gain drops by 3 dB from the mid-band value.

D.Unity Gain Bandwidth

For a single-pole amplifier, the gain-bandwidth product is constant and given by:

$$UGB = A_v \times BW$$

From AC analysis, $A_v = 6.8$ and $BW = 131.8 \text{ MHz}$,

hence:

$UGB = 6.8 \times 131.8 \approx 896 \text{ MHz}$, which is close to the unity gain frequency observed in the plot ($\approx 913 \text{ MHz}$).

RESULT

The PMOS Common Source amplifier was successfully designed and simulated using TSMC 180 nm technology. The DC operating point obtained from simulation showed a **drain current of approximately 247 μA** and an **output voltage of about 0.59 V**, confirming proper biasing in the saturation region. Transient analysis demonstrated that the output signal was amplified and inverted with respect to the input, verifying common source operation. AC analysis provided a stable **mid-band voltage gain of about 6.8 V/V** (approximately 16.9 dB). The **theoretical bandwidth** was calculated as **132.6 MHz**,

while the **simulated bandwidth** was observed to be around **131.8 MHz**. The **unity gain bandwidth** obtained from the frequency response was approximately **913 MHz**, which closely matched the gain–bandwidth product.

INFERENCE

The experimental results closely matched the theoretical calculations, validating the design approach of the PMOS Common Source amplifier. DC analysis confirmed saturation operation ensuring linear amplification. Transient analysis verified proper signal amplification with 180-degree phase inversion. AC analysis demonstrated expected gain and bandwidth characteristics of a single-pole amplifier. The close agreement between theoretical and simulated values highlights the effectiveness of combining analytical design with LTspice simulation. This experiment confirms the practical applicability of PMOS CS amplifiers in analog CMOS circuit design.